impossible for many Muslim immigrants to India to prove under its Citizenship (Amendment) Act 2019.[8] What unfolded in Myanmar is all too well known, and it augurs badly for what risks unfolding in India. There were decades of discrimination against the Rohingya in education, housing and employment, before it culminated in 2017 in the mass expulsion of 7,00,000 of them to Bangladesh. India too now wants to embark on a futile and costly exercise of determining which of its 1.3 billion residents are eligible for citizenship, fearing that it is being swamped by illegal Muslim migration from Bangladesh.

As in Myanmar, Indian Muslims will have to prove that they were resident in India upon Independence in 1947 or risk detention and deportation as illegal immigrants, whereas other religious groups will not. The entire scheme is an exercise of monumental folly. Not only will it be impracticable to remove millions of Muslims from their communities of sustainable livelihood at a time when the Indian economy is in the doldrums and place them in detention camps where they will be fed and maintained at public expense, but it will be well nigh impossible to deport those who have no documentation to a country of which they are not citizens. Yet, India's first and largest detention centre at Goalpara in Assam, the size of seven football grounds, has already been built to hold up to 3,000 illegal immigrants, and ten further centres are planned across this north-eastern state of India.[9] Small wonder then that Professor Chaman Lal has felt inclined to point out that, 'in present situation when a saffron build-up was trying to choke up the very Constitution of India and the concept of a nation' that Bhagat Singh and his comrades fought and died for, especially given that men like 'Bhagat Singh were undoubtedly patriotic and secular but the current fascist build-up in the country was trying to promote him by subverting his hallmark – rationalism and scientific temper'.[10] In fact, the actions of the Myanmar government suitably saw it in the dock when on 11 November 2019, the International Court of Justice at the Hague heard an application by the Gambia against it, alleging violation of the obligations under the Genocide Convention in which it succeeded.[11] It is not inconceivable that the same may happen to the Indian government were it